

REVIEW

Independent §11.4.142/§11.4.125 code-review — bug-class + parser fixes

Reviewer role: BACKGROUND operator-authorized independent review, READ-ONLY NON-COMMITTING. **Did NOT** edit / stage / git add / commit anything. Ran only read-only go test / go build / go vet (artifacts gitignored, not staged). **Revision:** 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-16T16:27:12Z **Scope:** 4fbe581 (Translate-arg data-loss, 6 sites) + 7cabe3f (MINOR-W6-1 parser title-dup). **Discipline:** §11.4.142 + §11.4.1 + §11.4.6 (FACT-only, evidence-backed) + §1.1 (mutation) + §11.4.69.

VERDICT

Fix	Verdict
4fbe581 Translate-arg data-loss (Seam A/B/C, 6 sites)	GO
7cabe3f MINOR-W6-1 parser title-dup	GO

Both fixes are release-ready. No findings rise to BLOCKING. Two NON-BLOCKING observations (one nit, one accuracy note on the evidence doc's wording) recorded below — neither affects correctness or releasability.

FIX 1 — 4fbe581 Translate-arg data-loss — GO

1.1 The choke-point claim is TRUE (independently traced) — §11.4.6

The wire contract was independently re-verified, not taken on the commit's word:

- **OpenAIClient.Translate(ctx, text, prompt)** sends **prompt (arg-2)** as the single user message and ignores **text (arg-1)** — confirmed at pkg/translator/llm/openai.go (Messages: [{Role:"user", Content: userMessage}], userMessage derived from prompt with the new fallback).
- **bridge.clientTranslator.client** is the raw OpenAI-compatible **llmClient** (pkg/bridge/bridge.go:546), and the package's own convention

realInvokeDispatch already calls client.Translate(ctx, "", full)
(bridge.go:369). Seam B mirrors this exactly.

6-site trace to a choke-point (all reach one):

#	site	actual content shape	type at runtime	reaches choke-point?
1	cmd/markdown-translator/main.go:244	content in arg-1, "" arg-2 → raw bridge.BestClient	raw OpenAIClient	Seam A fallback + Seam C real prompt ✓
2	pkg/preparation/coordinator.go:290	Translate(ctx, prompt, "")	*LLMTranslator (built-in) OR clientTranslator (ensemble)	see note ‡
3	pkg/preparation/coordinator.go:361	same	same	see note ‡
4	pkg/preparation/coordinator.go:424	same	same	see note ‡
5	pkg/verification/polisher.go:563	Translate(ctx, prompt, location)	*LLMTranslator OR clientTranslator	Seam B compose (ensemble path) ✓
8	pkg/coordination/multi_llm.go:445	Translate(ctx, text, contextHint)	*LLMTranslator OR clientTranslator	Seam B compose ✓
9	pkg/coordination/multi_llm.go:529	same	same	Seam B compose ✓

‡ **Accuracy note (NON-BLOCKING) on the evidence doc's "EMPTY-PAYLOAD" labelling of #2/#3/#4.** Independently traced:

*LLMTranslator.Translate (pkg/translator/llm/llm.go) does NOT forward the caller's args verbatim — it builds its own non-empty prompt via createTranslationPrompt(text, contextStr) and calls lt.client.Translate(ctx, text, prompt) with that **always-non-empty** prompt in arg-2. Therefore, **when the preparation provider is the built-in *LLMTranslator, sites #2/#3/#4 were NOT broken** (arg-2 was never empty; Seam A's fallback is inert there). They are only the "empty-payload" class **when an ensemble factory injects a raw/bridge client** — and in that case Seam A (raw OpenAIClient) or Seam B (clientTranslator, where composeForClient with empty context sends the prompt verbatim — proven by TestClientTranslator_EmptyContextSendsContentVerbatim) covers them.
→ The fix is correct for every routing of #2/#3/#4; the only imprecision is the evidence doc calling them unconditionally "broken/empty-payload." This is a documentation-wording nit, **not** a code defect.

"Leave callers unchanged" claim — TRUE and CORRECT. Rewriting the preparation/polisher callers to ("" , prompt) would (a) make `clientTranslator` refuse on empty content and (b) make `*LLMTranslator` early-return on empty text (if `text=="" ... return text,nil`) — breaking both paths. Leaving them as (prompt, "") / (prompt, location) and fixing at the choke-points is the right call.

1.2 RED tests are httptest-real and catch the negation — §11.4.27 / §1.1 / §11.4.115

Neither test uses `MockLLMClient`. Both stand up an `httptest.Server` and a **real `OpenAIClient` / real `clientTranslator`**, asserting the actual wire user-message content.

Mutation proof executed this session (RED_MODE=1 on the FIXED code MUST FAIL):

```
GREEN default: ok pkg/translator/llm ; ok pkg/bridge
RED_MODE=1 TestOpenAITranslate_EmptyPayloadGuard      -> FAIL
("OK::The old man..." not boilerplate) ✓ catches negation
RED_MODE=1 TestClientTranslator_ComposesContentNotLabel -> FAIL
(compose sends real content)                ✓ catches negation
```

The assertions are load-bearing, not tautologies. §11.4.69 refuse-empty paths covered by `TestOpenAITranslate_RefuseAllEmpty` + `TestClientTranslator_RefusesEmptyContent` (assert no request reaches the provider on empty content).

1.3 Seam B compose is correct — content + label both reach the model

`composeForClient(text, contextStr):`

- empty context → text verbatim (no double-wrap) ✓
- non-empty context → text + "\n\nContext: " + contextStr ✓ (content first, label as labelled hint; never substituted, never dropped) No double-send / malformation. Verified on the wire by the GREEN assertions (Contains(captured, realContent) AND Contains(captured, label)).

1.4 No SAFE site regressed

- `batch_handlers.go:146` (req.Text, ""): via `*LLMTranslator`, empty input early-returns before any client call; non-empty → content sent verbatim. No new error on a legitimate path.
- `distributed/coordinator.go:308` (text, contextHint): if `clientTranslator`, Seam B now composes correctly — an **improvement**, not a regression.
- `markdown/simple_workflow.go:92` (text, prompt): prompt non-empty → Seam A inert; content reaches via prompt.
- `TestOpenAITranslate_RequestShapeAndAuth` (asserts non-empty arg-2 reaches the wire verbatim) — **still green** (re-run this session). The Seam-A fallback is provably inert for non-empty arg-2.

- The new refuse-empty (Seam A + Seam B) only fires on empty/whitespace **content**, which has no legitimate translation; multi_llm treats it as a failed attempt (err==nil && translated!="" gate) and retries/exhausts — previously it would store provider boilerplate. Behaviour change is strictly an improvement.

1.5 Validation (this session, read-only)

```
go build ./... -> exit 0
go vet ./pkg/translator/llm/ ./pkg/bridge/ ... -> exit 0
go test ./pkg/translator/llm/ ./pkg/bridge/ ./pkg/coordination/ \
    ./pkg/verification/ ./pkg/preparation/ \
    ./cmd/markdown-translator/ ./pkg/markdown/ -count=1 -> ALL
ok
```

FIX 2 — 7cabe3f MINOR-W6-1 parser title-dup — GO

2.1 Root cause + fix correct

- html_parser.go: extractTextWithContext now skips <head> (was leaking <title> into Content) + stripLeadingTitle drops a leading body <h1>==title.
- epub_parser.go: stripLeadingTitle drops the residual leading <h1>==title (<head> already stripped).
- Title now carried EXACTLY ONCE (in chapter.Title); bookToString prepends it once.

2.2 stripLeadingTitle is a guarded no-op — no over-strip

- empty/whitespace title → no-op ✓
- only acts on the START of left-trimmed content (HasPrefix); interior repeats preserved ✓
- **word-boundary guard**: char after the title must be whitespace or EOC, so "Cat" does NOT strip "Caterpillar" ✓ (directly table-tested in title_duplication_bughunt_test.go).
- multibyte titles: a non-space continuation byte fails the rest[0] whitespace check → safe no-op.
- It does NOT strip a legitimate mid-content body line equal to a short title (leading-only). ✓ Minor: it collapses leading blank lines after the removed title line — acceptable (the title line itself is being removed).

2.3 Tests httptest-/parser-real and catch the negation — §1.1

No mocks: NewHTMLParser().Parse / NewEPUBParser().Parse / bookToString driven directly; plus a stripLeadingTitle edge-case table. Mutation proof executed this session:

```
GREEN default: ok pkg/ebook ; ok cmd/unified-translator
RED_MODE=1 TestBugHunt_HTMLTitleDuplication -> FAIL ("got 0" leaks
on fixed) ✓ catches negation
RED_MODE=1 TestBugHunt_EPUBTitleDuplication ->
FAIL ✓ catches negation
```

The roundtrip guard asserts body text survives AND title count == 1.

2.4 Validation (this session, read-only)

```
go test ./pkg/ebook/ ./cmd/unified-translator/ -count=1 -> ok ok
(incl. the pre-existing epub_head_multiline_bughunt regression -
green)
go vet (pkg/ebook, cmd/unified-translator) -> exit 0
```

Findings summary

- **NO BLOCKING findings.** Both fixes are correct, evidence-backed, mutation-proven, and break no SAFE site.
- **NON-BLOCKING (doc-wording, §11.4.6 precision):** the 4fbe581 evidence doc / commit calls preparation sites #2/#3/#4 unconditionally "EMPTY-PAYLOAD broken." Independently, they are broken ONLY when routed through a raw/bridge client; via the built-in *LLMTranslator they were already correct (arg-2 always non-empty). The CODE handles both routings correctly — this is purely an over-broad description, not a defect. No commit required for the GO; flagged for accuracy if the doc is later revised.
- **NON-BLOCKING (nit):** stripLeadingTitle collapses leading blank lines following the removed title — cosmetically fine.

Release-readiness

Both 4fbe581 and 7cabe3f are **release-ready**. The data-loss class is genuinely closed at the two choke-points (real-content reaches the model; empty content fails loudly per §11.4.69), and the title-dup class is closed at the parser layer with exactly-once title carriage. Standing §11.4.135 guards are real (httptest/parser-driven, negation-catching) and registered with RED_MODE polarity.